happened between the two except inquiring about each other's welfare. Soon they left for their respective ways.

But winter was soon set to march in and Samarkand eventually was devoid of any crisis. Believing that this was not the right time for any action, Babur retired to Andijān and Ali Mīrzā to Bukhara. Babur mentions that Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā was in awe of Shaikh Abdullah Barla's daughter. Perhaps, she was the only reason that had drawn him to Samarkand. He took her and marched back to Ḥisār keeping aside his previous ambition of conquering the world.

Babur's Second Attempt on Samarkand

As the winter came, Baysonqor Mīrzā performed well to consolidate his position. When Abdul Karim Ushrit came forward on the part of Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā near Kufin, Mahdi Sulṭān took the lead on the part of Baysonqor Mīrzā's troops. Mahdi and Abdul got into an unavoidable face-off.

Mahdi Sulṭān proved to be an active warrior very early. He pricked Abdul's horse with his *Chirkas* sword and it came down, neighing loudly. In the next attack, Mahdi's sword hit Abdul's wrist and he lay sniffing the earth. Abdul was captured and his troop was thrashed black and blue. Seeing the change of wind in Samarkand and hoping for the tittering of the gates of Tīmūrid Mīrzās, the cunning Aūzbeg Sulṭāns thought of opening the country for Muhammad Shaybāni Khān.

Now the situation was becoming uglier.

However limited the success of the Samarkandis may have been over Abdul Karim, it had made them highly motivated. Now they drew their army against Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā. Baysonqor Mīrzā went to the Sar-i-Pul (bridgehead) and Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā rushed to Khwaja Karzun. Meantime, Khwaja Abul Makaram, at the insistence of Khwaja Munir of Osh rode to Bukhara along with Wais Laghari, Muhammad Baqir (a leader of Andijāni Begs), Qasim Duldai and some from the house of Mīrzās. But the *Bukhariots* were well prepared for the invaders. The news of their readiness reached Abul Makaram and company. Feeling hopeless, Abdul decided to retire from the scenario.